

Acme Corporation Employee Handbook

HR Policy Manual — Edition 2022 (Superseded)

Section 1. Introduction

This handbook describes the employment policies of Acme Corporation for the 2022 calendar year. It supersedes the 2021 edition in full. Where a provision conflicts with local law, local law prevails. Questions regarding interpretation should be directed to the People Operations team at people-ops@acmecorp.example.

Acme Corporation operates in 14 countries and employs approximately 3,100 people worldwide. The policies in this handbook apply to all regular full-time and part-time employees unless explicitly stated otherwise. Contractors and interns are governed by separate agreements and are not covered by the leave, bonus, or equity provisions below.

Section 2. Working Hours and Remote Work

2.1 Standard Hours

Standard working hours are 40 hours per week, typically Monday through Friday, 9:00 to 18:00 local time with a one-hour lunch break. Core collaboration hours are 11:00 to 16:00. Employees on flexible schedules must remain reachable during core hours.

2.2 Remote Work

Employees may work remotely up to 2 days per week. There is no mandatory in-office day during 2022. Fully remote arrangements require director-level approval and are reviewed annually. Acme provides a one-time \$400 home office stipend to employees who elect remote work. The stipend is taxable and disbursed with the next payroll cycle.

Remote employees must maintain a dedicated workspace with a reliable internet connection of at least 25 Mbps download and 10 Mbps upload. Company-issued laptops must be used for all work. Personal devices may be used only for incidental access to email and calendar.

Section 3. Compensation

3.1 Salary Reviews

Salary reviews occur annually in March, with adjustments effective April 1. In 2022, the merit increase pool was set at 3.5 percent of total base salary. Promotions are considered separately and may result in adjustments of 8 to 15 percent depending on level change.

3.2 Bonus Plan

The annual performance bonus target is 10 percent of base salary for individual contributors, 15 percent for managers, and 25 percent for directors and above. Bonuses are paid in March following the close of the fiscal year and are prorated for employees hired mid-year.

3.3 Equity

New hires receive a restricted stock unit (RSU) grant with a four-year vesting schedule and a one-year cliff. Refresh grants are awarded annually to high performers and are typically 25 to 50 percent of the original grant size.

Section 4. Leave Policies

4.1 Paid Time Off

Full-time employees accrue 18 days of PTO per year, plus 10 company holidays. PTO accrues at 1.5 days per month. Unused PTO may be carried over up to 5 days into the following calendar year. PTO requests must be submitted through the Workday portal at least 5 business days in advance for absences of three days or more.

4.2 Sick Leave

Employees receive 8 days of paid sick leave annually. Sick leave does not carry over between calendar years. For absences exceeding three consecutive days, a physician's note may be requested by the manager. Sick leave may be used to care for an immediate family member.

4.3 Parental Leave

Effective January 2022, Acme offers 12 weeks of fully paid parental leave for primary caregivers and 6 weeks for secondary caregivers. Leave must be taken in a single continuous block within 12 months of the child's birth, adoption, or placement. Employees must notify HR at least 90 days in advance, or as soon as practicable in cases of emergency placement or premature birth.

4.4 Bereavement Leave

Employees may take up to 5 days of paid bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling) and up to 2 days for extended family. Additional unpaid leave may be arranged with manager approval.

4.5 Jury Duty

Employees summoned for jury duty receive full pay for the duration of service, up to 15 business days per year. Documentation from the court must be submitted to HR within 5 days of receiving the summons.

Section 5. Code of Conduct

5.1 Standards

All employees are expected to act with integrity, treat colleagues with respect, and avoid conflicts of interest. Compliance training must be completed by June 30 each year. Failure to complete training by the deadline may result in suspension of system access.

5.2 Reporting Violations

Violations of the code of conduct should be reported to the Ethics Hotline at ethics@acmecorp.example or 1-800-555-0142. Reports may be made anonymously. Retaliation against reporters is strictly prohibited and is grounds for immediate termination.

Section 6. Separation

6.1 Notice Period

Employees resigning voluntarily must provide written notice of at least 30 days. Managers and above must provide 60 days. Notice may be waived or shortened by mutual agreement.

6.2 Final Pay

Final pay is issued on the next regularly scheduled payroll date following the last day of employment, in accordance with local law. Unused accrued PTO is paid out where required by law.